



Plants for gravel gardens

Gravel adds a decorative finish to designs, and is particularly suitable for gardens with sandy soil and drought-tolerant plants.

Take inspiration from the designs of celebrated English plantswoman Beth Chatto, who transformed a dry and dusty parking lot into a world-famous garden using plants that need no watering and take care of themselves once established. To recreate this on a smaller scale, combine plants with different forms and textures, such as spiky blue oat grass, flat-topped yarrow, and daisy-flowered golden marguerites. Tough annuals, including California poppies, will self-seed in the gravel, creating a naturalistic effect, while bulbs, such as ornamental onions, tulips, and spider lilies, add seasonal highlights from spring to fall.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

***Achillea* 'Coronation Gold'**

YARROW This upright perennial has fernlike gray-green leaves and, in summer, bears flattened heads of golden-yellow flowers that are highly attractive to bees. Can be short-lived; has tall but sturdy stems.

↑3ft (1m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z3-9



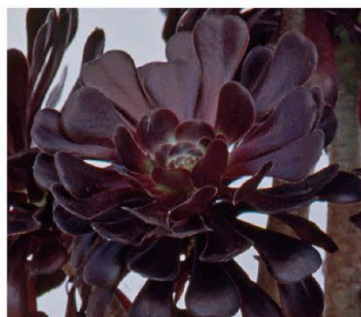
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

***Achillea* 'Summerwine'**

YARROW This upright perennial has feathery dark green leaves. In summer, it produces flat heads of white-eyed crimson flowers that fade to pink. Plant it toward the front of a border; it may require staking.

↑↔32in (80cm)

☀ Z3-9



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

***Aeonium* 'Zwartkop'**

PURPLE CREST AEONIUM This tender evergreen perennial is grown for its rosettes of fleshy, glossy dark purple-black leaves produced on branching stems. Protect it from frost during winter by bringing it under cover.

↑24in (60cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z9-11



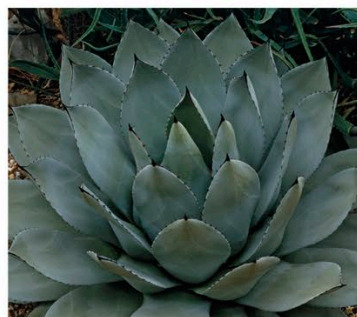
PERENNIAL MEDIUM

***Agastache* 'Black Adder'**

HYSSOP An upright perennial with lance-shaped bright green leaves and spikes of fluffy violet-purple flowers, which appear from late summer to mid-fall. Plant in a sheltered spot with grasses and round-headed flowers, such as dahlias.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ Z6-9



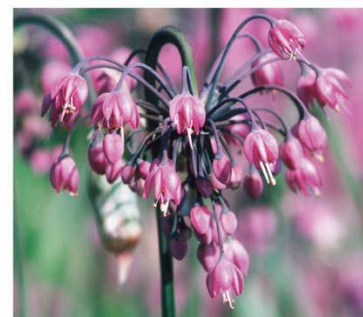
PERENNIAL SMALL

***Agave* parryi**

CENTURY PLANT A succulent evergreen perennial with large rosette of spiky gray-green to blue-green leaves. Protect from freezing temperatures during winter by covering or bringing it under cover. Use it as a statement plant in a gravel bed.

↑20in (50cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀ Z7-11 (N)



BULB LARGE

***Allium* cernuum**

NODDING ONION This upright perennial bulb produces strap-shaped gray-green leaves that fade before the tall stems holding clusters of pendent purplish pink flowers appear in summer. Plant the bulbs in bold groups in fall.

↑28in (70cm)

☀ Z3-9 (N)



BULB LARGE

***Allium* 'Purple Sensation'**

FLOWERING ONION An upright perennial bulb with strap-shaped gray-green foliage, which fades as sturdy stems of deep violet spherical flower heads appear in early summer. Plant the bulbs in fall between other plants that will hide its dying leaves.

↑32in (80cm)

☀ Z3-8



PERENNIAL SMALL

***Anaphalis* triplinervis**

PEARLY EVERLASTING This is a low-growing, clump-forming perennial that produces lance-shaped pale gray-green leaves and clusters of small white flowers in summer. It is useful as a cut or dried flower.

↑20in (50cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀ Z3-8



PERENNIAL SMALL

***Androsace* carnea**

ROCK JASMINE A mound-forming, dwarf evergreen perennial with linear green leaves and rounded clusters of yellow-eyed pink flowers, which appear in late spring. Use it between paving stones set into a gravel path.

↑↔2in (5cm)

☀ Z4-7